

THE BATTLE OF ANGIARI

The Battle of Angiari was fought on June 29, 1440, between the forces of Milan on one side and the combined forces of Florence, Venice, and the Papal States on the other. The Milanese army was bigger and hoped for a surprise attack, but the dust that the horses raised on the road gave away their advance. The opposing troops battled fiercely, and after hours of fighting that continued into the night, Florence and its allies proved victorious.

At first, Leonardo threw all his energies into the project. The sketches he did showed a group of soldiers on horseback desperately fighting for the enemy's flag, their faces reflecting the grim horrors of war.

To make the moment come truly alive, Leonardo wrote in his notes of the need to show the smoke of gunfire, mixed with air and dust, which was stirred by the the movement of horses and soldiers fighting.

